

Metformin

Product Information

BRAND / TRADE NAMES

Glucophage | Glumetza | Fortamet | Riomet

HOW SUPPLIED

Metformin HCl 500 mg tablets: white to off-white, round, film-coated tablets. Available in bottles of 100 tablets and bottles of 500 tablets.

STORAGE & HANDLING

Store at 20–25 degrees C (68–77 degrees F). Excursions permitted to 15–30 degrees C (59–86 degrees F). Keep container tightly closed. Protect from light and moisture.

This brochure is intended for healthcare professionals only. Please refer to the full prescribing information before clinical use. Data sourced from the US FDA OpenFDA database.

metformin
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metformin hydrochloride

Biguanide Antidiabetic Agent

Manufactured by Bristol-Myers Squibb Company

PRESCRIBING INFORMATION BROCHURE

Clinical Information

INDICATIONS & USAGE

Metformin HCl tablets are indicated as an adjunct to diet and exercise to improve glycemic control in adults and pediatric patients 10 years of age and older with type 2 diabetes mellitus.

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Contraindicated in patients with: Severe renal impairment (eGFR below 30 mL/min/1.73 m2). Hypersensitivity to metformin. Acute or chronic metabolic acidosis, including diabetic ketoacidosis with or without coma.

Drug Overview

DESCRIPTION

Metformin hydrochloride is an oral antihyperglycemic drug used in the management of type 2 diabetes mellitus. It is not chemically or pharmacologically related to any other class of oral antihyperglycemic agents. Metformin decreases hepatic glucose production, decreases intestinal absorption of glucose, and improves insulin sensitivity by increasing peripheral glucose uptake and utilization.

DOSAGE & ADMINISTRATION

Adults: Starting dose 500 mg orally twice daily or 850 mg once daily with meals. Increase in increments of 500 mg weekly or 850 mg every 2 weeks, up to a maximum dose of 2550 mg per day in divided doses. Doses above 2000 mg may be better tolerated given 3 times daily with meals. Pediatrics (10–16 years): Starting dose 500 mg twice daily with meals; maximum 2000 mg per day.

Safety Information

WARNINGS & PRECAUTIONS

Lactic Acidosis: Postmarketing cases of metformin-associated lactic acidosis have resulted in death, hypothermia, hypotension, and resistant bradyarrhythmias. Symptoms include malaise, myalgias, respiratory distress, somnolence, and abdominal pain. Discontinue if lactic acidosis is suspected. Vitamin B12 Deficiency: Metformin may lower vitamin B12 levels; measure hematological parameters annually.

ADVERSE REACTIONS

Most common adverse reactions (greater than 5%): diarrhea, nausea and vomiting, flatulence, asthenia, indigestion, abdominal discomfort, and headache. Decreased Vitamin B12 levels observed in approximately 7% of patients in controlled clinical trials.